



OILMAN ON THE LOOKOUT

OIL & GAS MINISTER Hardeep Singh Puri must be partially relieved after state-owned oil marketing firms raised fuel prices for the first time in four months. Crude oil prices have steadily risen since the start of Russian military action in Ukraine,

eroding the margins of players like IOCL, HPCL and BPCL. The 70-year-old former diplomat also told the Rajya Sabha that he was weighing in on potential investment opportunities in Russian oil and gas assets if western oil majors exited the country.

—MANISH PANT



COVID KILLER

FINALLY, CHILDREN aged 12 to 15 years can get their own vaccine for Covid-19. And that is thanks to Mahima Datla, whose company Biological E. has already produced 300 million vaccine doses for the central government. Datla, MD of the company, says Biological E. will also partner with state governments, hospitals and medical institutions to facilitate the supply of Corbevax, and the company has installed capacity to produce over 100 million doses per month.

—NEETU CHANDRA SHARMA

WHERE THERE IS A YOGI...

Baba Ramdev has an opinion on practically all things, and these days, especially on matters FMCG. The trait was on full display when he faced media queries during the launch of Ruchi Soya's follow-on public offering (FPO). Asked about the recently-listed Adani Wilmar, Ramdev was quick to say that Adani Wilmar is just an oil company while Ruchi Soya has a strong presence in FMCG, food and nutraceuticals. Wherever there is a yogi, everything is possible, he quipped.

—ASHISH RUKHAIYAR



Baba Ramdev has called Adani Wilmar just an oil company, while explaining that Ruchi Soya is present in FMCG, food and nutraceuticals



Family Strife

TOUGH TIMES have befallen **Analjit Singh**. An astute investor who made a pile of money in telecom, the Max Group founder is in the midst of a legal battle with his wife Neelu. In a petition filed with NCLT, Neelu has alleged fund diversions through sham transactions, in addition to being ousted from the business. Looks like a long haul.

—KRISHNA GOPALAN

META, INSTA, NFT



Good news for Insta influencers! Meta (Facebook) Founder **Mark Zuckerberg** at a conference in Texas, US, confirmed that Instagram would soon introduce non-fungible tokens (NFTs). The photo-sharing app is also likely to allow users to trade NFT profile pictures on the platform. This is in line with Zuckerberg's ambitions of building a metaverse that will be more like an extension of our current virtual avatars, but only more interactive. Instagram's entry into NFTs could mean anything from allowing users to mint their own tokens to selling a viral post as an NFT, and a lot of other cool stuff in between.

—PRERNA LIDHOO



Goel Stays

BY REAPPOINTING Jawa-har Goel as MD till March 2025, Dish TV's board has sent a clear message that it is in no mood to relent to pressure from its largest shareholder YES Bank to replace Goel—Subhash Chandra's brother; he has 5.93 per cent promoter shareholding in the company—and four directors. This comes after the re-appointment of non-executive and non-independent director Ashok Kurien was shot down at its AGM. What next for the company?

—VIDYA S.